

Mikoyan-Gurevich MiG-21 Russia 1959



External fuel tank

Exhaust for gases from turbojet engine

Lockheed SR71 Blackbird USA 1964



Outer cockpit windshield made of quartz can heat up to 572°F (300°C) when flying fast

BAe/Aerospatiale Concorde Type 1 UK/France 1976



Fuselage is 9ft 6in (2.9m) wide, 203ft (62m) long, and holds 100 passengers

Pilot sits in ejection seat



Yakovlev Yak-38 Russia 1971

Nosewheel supports the front of the aircraft

Hawker Siddeley Harrier GR 3 UK 1973



Nose contains laser range finder to measure distances

Engine nozzle moves to direct thrust down or back

Blades nearly 25ft (7.6m) in length spun by turboshaft engine



Bell XV-15 Tiltrotor USA 1977

Engines tilt upward for takeoff and forward for level flight

Instrument boom

Bell Boeing MV-22B Osprey USA 2007



Tail fin

Fuselage can hold 32 armed troops

In 1990, an SR71 flew coast-to-coast across the entire USA in under 68 minutes.

the first to reach 1,242 mph (2,000 km/h), and the **MiG-21** topped 1,479 mph (2,380 km/h). Then, in 1976, the **Lockheed SR71 Blackbird**, a jet spy plane, set a record of 2,193 mph (3,529 km/h), which has not been broken since. VTOL aircraft are used in places without long runways. Some,

such as the **Hawker Siddeley Harrier GR 3** and **Yakovlev Yak-38**, have engine nozzles that move to direct thrust downward or behind. Tilt-rotor planes, such as the **Bell XV-15**, swivel their entire propeller-spinning engines upward for takeoff and forward for regular flight.